States of India, Vol. 1, London: Smith, Elder and Co., 1829, p. 321.

16 **'so ungenerous was this man and so low':** Ibid., p. 270.

16 **'was a rough old soldier':** Erskine quoted in Elliot (ed.), *The History of India, as Told by Its Own Historians*, p. 216fn.

17 **most senior woman of the household at this time was Khanzada Begum:** For details of her extraordinary life, see Ira Mukhoty, *Daughters of the Sun: Empresses, Queens and Begums of the Mughal Empire*, New Delhi: Aleph Book Company, 2018, p. 20.

17 **'The moon was in Leo,' wrote Gulbadan:** Gulbadan, *Humāyūn-Nāma*, p. 158.

17 **Maulana Chand 'was perturbed':** Beveridge (trans.), *Akbarnama*, Vol. 1, p. 19.

17 **'fell a'dancing, and from excess of exultation':** Moin, *The Millennium Sovereign*, p. 199.

17 **'This is all the present I can afford to make you':** Jauhar, *The Tazkereh Al Vakiāt, Or Private Memoirs of the Moghul Emperor Humāyūn*, Written in the Persian Language, translated by Major Charles Stewart, London: Oriental Translation Fund, 1832, p. 45.

18 **ten additional women were listed as having suckled Akbar:** Beveridge (trans.), *Akbarnama*, p. 131.

18 **'takht revan':** Edward Ives, *A Voyage from England to India*, London: Edward and Charles Dilly, 1773, p. 278.

18 **'much rejoiced by the arrival of so celebrated':** Jauhar, *The Tazkereh Al Vakiāt*, p. 47.

19 **'The people of Hindustan':** Ibid., p. 51.

19 **'there was not a chink of time':** Gulbadan, *Humāyūn-Nāma*, p. 165.

19 **it was Humayun who found it 'requisite':** Jauhar, *The Tazkereh Al Vakiāt*, p. 52.

19 **'the weather was very hot, so he [Akbar] was left behind':** Henry Miers Elliot, *The History of India, as Told by Its Own Historians: The Muhammadan Period, End of the Afghan Dynasty and the First Thirty-Eight Years of the Reign of Akbar*, edited by John Dowson, Vol. 5, London: Trübner and Co., 1873, p. 216.

19 **'under the protection of Divine love':** Beveridge (trans.), *Akbarnama*, Vol. 1, pp. 391–92.

20 **'he went hunting long ago':** Gulbadan, *Humāyūn-Nāma*, p. 165.

20 **speak of a 'river of milk':** Abraham Eraly, *Emperors of the Peacock Throne: The Saga of the Great Moghuls*, New Delhi: Penguin Books, 2000.

20 **'this striking and falling, are visibly before me':** Beveridge (trans.), *Akbarnama*, Vol. 1, p. 397.

21 **'They are the very hands and feet of my brother':** Gulbadan, *Humāyūn-Nāma*, p. 174.

21 **ordered the child to be weaned immediately:** Beveridge (trans.), *Akbarnama*, p. 456.

22 **'merely to look at him':** Gulbadan, *Humāyūn-Nāma*, p. 178.

22 **painting a polo match on a grain of rice:** Surya Tubach, 'The Astounding Miniature Paintings of India's Mughal Empire', *Art sy*, 30 April 2018.

22 **As art historian J. M. Rogers describes it:** Ibid.

22 **'situated in an exceptionally elevated place':** Thackston (trans.), *The Baburnama*, p. 152.

23 **The circumcision ceremony was an important rite of passage:** See Faruqui, *Princes of the Mughal Empire* for more details on rites of passage of Mughal princes.

23 **The banquet would have included biryan:** Colleen Taylor Sen, *Feasts and Fasts: A History of Food in India*, London: Reaktion Books, 2015, p. 184.

23 **'A few spoonfuls of fat are melted':** Arminius Vámbéry quoted in Lizzie Collingham, *Curry: A Tale of Cooks and Conquerors*, New Delhi: Oxford University Press, 2006, p. 19.

24 **'fruit pilaus, turmeric and saffron ones, chicken pilaus':** Ibid., p. 26.

24 **'fine sherbets of lemon and rosewater':** Taylor Sen, *Feasts and Fasts*, p. 182.

24 **the Kabul years were essential to the development of the Mughal school:** For in-depth discussion see Laura E. Parodi, 'Earliest datable Mughal painting', *Staatsbibliothek zu Berlin - Preussischer Kulturbesitz, Libr. Pict. A117, fol. 15a* [accessed: 2 January 2020].

24 **which employed Khurasani trained artists:** Ibid.